Performance Review & Appraisal Policy

The annual performance cycle: goal setting, mid-year check-in, year-end review, calibration, outcomes and the appeal path.

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EFFECTIVE	01 FEB 2026
FOR	ALL EMPLOYEES
CLASSIFICATION	INTERNAL / ALL EMPLOYEES

Our performance cycle runs March to February for India and calendar-year for US colleagues, and connects goals set at joining or each April to ratings, pay outcomes and promotion decisions. This document explains the cycle, what each phase is for, and where to raise a weak review.

1. The cycle

Phase	Timing	Output
Goal setting	April (or on joining)	Signed goals — business, role and growth
Mid-year check-in	August–September	Non-rated progress conversation, documented
Year-end self review	January	Self assessment against goals
Manager review	February	Manager commentary + proposed rating
Calibration	February	Unit-level moderation for consistency
Feedback & outcomes	March	Rating shared, increment/variable outcomes confirmed

2. How you are assessed

Ratings weigh two things together: what was delivered against agreed goals, and how it was delivered — conduct, collaboration and adherence to the code. No single metric, and certainly no last-quarter sprint, decides a rating.

3. Calibration and fairness

Proposed ratings are moderated in calibration panels with multiple managers present, to counter individual harshness or generosity. Panel notes are retained; if two consecutive cycles produce statistically lopsided distribution, HR audits the panel's reasoning.

4. Outcomes

- Increment and variable amounts follow the Compensation Structure & Payment Policy (KB-E-09).
- Promotion cases are decided in the same cycle using potential + sustained delivery, not on rating alone.
- A first-cycle low rating triggers a written improvement plan before any exit proposal.

5. If you disagree with your rating

First, have the conversation with your manager after the feedback — most differences end there. If it does not, you can appeal in an HR ticket within 10 working days of the rating being shared; a senior reviewer outside the calibration panel re-reads the year's evidence and replies within 15 working days. The reviewer's finding is final for the cycle.